

protects the backup is that, in case of a network-level infection, your drive is safe, and even if it is your system that is infected, the lack of accessibility of backup would mean that you would not risk infecting or losing the data by frantically plugging in the drive that is handy. Rather, you would take time to clean up your infected system thoroughly and then connect the backup drive to restore data.

Hide your Wi-Fi

This is like sorcery for the uninitiated, but when correctly configured, it does a lot. Hiding your Wi-Fi means that your network SSID (the name) would not be visible in regular scans done by the devices in the range of your router, but the ones who know what your network is named will still be able to connect to the network and use it as they normally would.

To do this, go to your router's settings page, and where there is the option about the SSID's visibility, turn that off. There are no specific steps that we can list here because this setting is very router specific, and each manufacturer has their own menu layout. But, for the most part, it is not hard to find. Once you have configured your router, your SSID will be taken off the radar of the devices that are within the range of your router. To connect a new device, what you would need to do is, enter the SSID of your network, and the password, and only then you will be able to connect to the Wi-Fi network.

Hide yourself

If you work with public networks, say in college and other such institutions, we recommend you turn off two options, which are, File Sharing and Network Discovery. What this does is that it takes your network, in a way, off the grid. With both these options turned off, your computer will not be discoverable by any other system on the network.

The option to turn off Network Discovery on MacOS devices can be found in the Firewall Options, labelled as stealth mode. For Windows users, this option is available in the Advanced Sharing settings menu. And, for turning off the File Sharing option, the setting is available under the Sharing menu in both MacOS and Windows devices.

Hide yourself (2)

In the last section, we told you how to hide your devices when connected to a network; now let us see how you can go incognito on social media.